PRACTICE EXAM 2 OF 4 · FOUNDATIONS - ALL DOMAINS

Practice exam 2

Twenty new questions in exam proportions, with a walkthrough after each and a scoring guide at the end.

QUESTIONS 20 PEOPLE 6 PROCESS 9 BUS ENV 5

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A construction schedule includes a seven-day lag for concrete to cure before walls can be built. This activity is on the critical path.

The site engineer says a proven additive would cut curing to three days, at a small extra cost within the project manager's authority.

What should the project manager do?

A Keep the seven-day lag, since it is in the approved schedule.

B Use the additive immediately without further checks.

C Confirm the additive meets quality and specification requirements, then approve it and update the schedule.

D Escalate the proposal to the sponsor.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Keep the lag.
Ignores an opportunity to shorten the critical path.

B Use it unchecked.
Skips the quality check a structural change needs.

C Check quality; approve; update schedule.
Exploits the opportunity safely, within authority.

D Escalate.
The cost is within the PM's authority.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. An opportunity on the critical path: check quality, then take it, within authority.

> A new agile team keeps asking its scrum master to decide which story each developer should pick up next, and how to split tasks within the sprint.
>
> The scrum master has been answering to keep things moving.

What should the scrum master do?

A Coach the team to make these decisions itself, for example by answering with questions rather than instructions.

B Continue deciding, since the team is new.

C Ask the product owner to assign the tasks instead.

D Write a detailed task allocation for each sprint.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the scrum master do?

A Coach self-organisation.
Builds the team's ability to manage its own work.

B Keep deciding.
Creates dependence, and a bottleneck in one person.

C The PO assigns tasks.
The PO owns what, not who does which task.

D Detailed task allocation.
Command and control; the opposite of self-management.

THE SIGNAL

People domain. Agile teams self-manage their work. The leader coaches, rather than directs.

> A supplier on a fixed price contract asks for a price increase because the published steel index has risen 8 percent. Unlike practice exam 1's supplier, this contract includes an economic price adjustment clause tied to that index.
>
> The supplier has provided the index figures.

What should the project manager do?

A Refuse, since the price is fixed.

B Negotiate a new price from scratch.

C Escalate the request to the sponsor.

D Verify the index figures, and apply the adjustment exactly as the clause defines.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Refuse.
Ignores a clause both parties agreed.

B Renegotiate.
The clause already defines the answer.

C Escalate.
Applying an agreed clause is routine contract administration.

D Verify, then apply the clause.
The contract anticipated this; follow it exactly.

THE SIGNAL

Business Environment domain. Paired with exam 1, question 7: this time the contract has a clause, so apply it.

> An agile team's increments meet its definition of done, but the operations team repeatedly cannot deploy them without days of extra work on configuration and monitoring.
>
> Releases are being delayed.

What should the project leader do?

A Ask operations to work faster on deployments.

B Work with the team and operations to add deployment readiness to the definition of done.

C Add a separate deployment phase at the end of every release.

D Accept the delays as normal for agile work.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project leader do?

A Operations work faster.

Blames the receivers for work that should have been done earlier.

B Deployment readiness in the DoD.

Makes 'done' mean usable, with operations as a customer.

C A deployment phase.

Batches the problem at the end instead of preventing it.

D Accept delays.

Agile aims for releasable increments, not delayed ones.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. If 'done' is not deployable, the definition of done is incomplete. Operations is a customer.

> In steering meetings, a powerful department head repeatedly argues against a hybrid project. Privately, a colleague mentions he believes the project will cut his department's budget.
>
> The project is approved and funded.

What should the project manager do?

A Ask the sponsor to instruct him to support the project.

B Exclude him from future steering discussions.

C Meet him privately to understand his concerns, and look for ways the project can address his interests.

D Ignore the opposition, since the project is approved.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Sponsor instructs him.
Compliance, not support; the concern stays hidden.

B Exclude him.
Turns open opposition into something worse.

C Private meeting; address interests.
Finds the real interest behind the position.

D Ignore him.
A powerful opponent can still derail delivery.

THE SIGNAL

People domain. Behind a position is an interest. Find it privately before trying to change the position.

A risk owner responsible for eight risks on a predictive project has left the organisation. Two of those risks have triggers expected within the next month.

Nobody has taken over the risks.

What should the project manager do first?

A Assign new owners to the eight risks, starting with those near their triggers, and review their responses.

B Take personal ownership of all eight risks permanently.

C Remove the risks from the register until new owners are found.

D Report the departure to the steering committee.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do first?

A Reassign owners, urgent ones first.

A risk without an owner has no one to act on its trigger.

B PM owns all eight.

Owners should be the people best placed to act, not one person for everything.

C Remove them.

The risks still exist; removing them hides them.

D Report to steering.

Reporting does not assign anyone to act.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. Every risk needs an owner who can act on its trigger. Fix ownership, urgent risks first.

> An agile team's velocity has averaged 30 points over the last six sprints. In sprint planning, the product owner pushes the team to commit to 50 points, to catch up on a release.
>
> The developers are uneasy but reluctant to argue.

What should the scrum master do?

A Support the 50-point commitment to meet the release.

B Tell the product owner the release date must move.

C Let the developers decide privately, without the product owner.

D Help the team plan to its measured capacity, and help the product owner adjust scope or expectations for the release.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the scrum master do?

A Commit to 50.
Two-thirds above measured velocity. almost certain failure, or cut corners.

B Move the date.
One option, but the scrum master does not decide it.

C Plan without the PO.
Sprint planning includes the product owner.

D Plan to capacity; help the PO adjust.
Honest planning, and a real conversation about scope or date.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. Plan to measured velocity. The gap becomes a scope or date decision for the product owner.

> An internal audit finds that a hybrid project has been deleting test records after each release. A regulation requires such records to be kept for seven years.
>
> Six months of records are already gone.

What should the project manager do?

A Continue deleting records, since the audit is complete.

B Stop the deletion, put retention in place as the regulation requires, and report the gap through the compliance process.

C Recreate the deleted records from memory.

D Keep the finding within the project team.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Carry on deleting.
Continues a known breach.

B Stop, retain, report.
Contain, fix, and report a compliance gap honestly.

C Recreate from memory.
Fabricated records are worse than missing ones.

D Keep it quiet.
Concealment turns a gap into misconduct.

THE SIGNAL

Business Environment domain. A compliance gap: contain it, fix it, report it. Never fabricate or hide.

A predictive project team worked extra hours for several weeks and delivered a major milestone two weeks early. Delighted, the sponsor offers the project manager a personal bonus.

The team has not been recognised.

What should the project manager do?

A Thank the sponsor, and ask that the team's contribution be recognised, suggesting team-based recognition.

B Accept the bonus, since the project manager is accountable for the milestone.

C Decline the bonus and say nothing more.

D Accept the bonus and share it privately with the team.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Credit the team; suggest team recognition.
Recognises the people who did the work, openly and fairly.

B Accept it alone.
Takes individual credit for team effort; damages trust.

C Decline silently.
The team still goes unrecognised.

D Share it privately.
Well-meant, but informal and not the organisation's recognition.

THE SIGNAL

People domain. Recognition belongs to those who did the work. Make it visible and team-based.

> The architecture lead and product owner agreed in a corridor conversation to drop a planned integration. Nobody recorded or shared the decision.
>
> Two weeks later, part of the team is still building the integration.

What should the project manager do to prevent this recurring?

A Ask the architecture lead not to make decisions informally.

B Hold a daily meeting for all decisions.

C Ask the team to check with the architecture lead before starting any work.

D Agree that decisions are recorded in a decision log and shared through the agreed channels.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do to prevent this recurring?

A Ban informal decisions.
Decisions happen anywhere; recording them is the fix.

B Daily decision meeting.
Heavy, and still does not record or share decisions.

C Check with one person first.
Creates a bottleneck instead of transparency.

D Decision log, shared routinely.
Makes every decision visible to everyone affected.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. Decisions nobody recorded get acted on twice. Log them and share them.

A supplier on a predictive project reports a shortage of the specified pump model, and proposes a substitute it says is equivalent. The substitute's datasheet differs slightly on pressure rating.

The installation date is five weeks away.

What should the project manager do?

A. Accept the substitute, since the supplier says it is equivalent.

B. Have the substitute evaluated against the specification, and if acceptable, agree it through the contract's change process.

C. Reject the substitute and wait for the original model.

D. Let the installation team decide on site.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Take the supplier's word.
The datasheet already shows a difference that matters.

B Evaluate; agree via contract change.
Checks quality, and changes the contract formally if accepted.

C Reject and wait.
Rejects a possibly acceptable option before evaluating it.

D Decide on site.
An informal, constructive change, made too late.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. A substitute is a change to the contract and the specification. Evaluate, then change formally.

> Updated climate forecasts show a wetter rainy season than usual during the months a predictive project plans its excavation and foundations.
>
> The current risk register assumes normal rainfall.

What should the project manager do?

A Wait to see whether the forecast is accurate.

B Move all groundworks to the following year.

C Update the risk register, analyse the impact, and plan responses such as re-sequencing or extra drainage.

D Report the forecast to the sponsor and take no further action.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Wait.
Loses time to prepare for a foreseeable risk.

B Move everything a year.
A drastic response before analysis.

C Update the register; analyse; plan responses.
A changed external condition becomes a managed risk.

D Report only.
Informs without managing the risk.

THE SIGNAL

Business Environment domain. New external information changes a risk. Update, analyse, respond.

> An agile team says growing technical debt is slowing every sprint and causing defects. The product owner keeps ordering new features above all clean-up work.
>
> The disagreement has become tense.

What should the project leader do?

A Facilitate a discussion that makes the cost of the technical debt visible, so the product owner can decide with full information.

B Tell the team to fix the debt without telling the product owner.

C Support the product owner and ask the team to stop raising it.

D Escalate the disagreement to the sponsor.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project leader do?

A Make the cost visible; PO decides.
Turns a tense disagreement into an informed decision.

B Fix it secretly.
Hides work from the product owner, and breaks transparency.

C Silence the team.
Suppresses useful task conflict and real information.

D Escalate.
A facilitated conversation has not been tried.

THE SIGNAL

People domain. Collaborate: make the trade-off visible, and let the owner decide with evidence.

> To meet sprint commitments, an agile team has started skipping some automated tests, even though its definition of done requires them. Escaped defects are rising.
>
> The team says it had no choice.

What should the scrum master do?

A Remove the automated tests from the definition of done.

B Ask a separate testing team to catch up on the tests later.

C Extend the sprint length to fit the tests.

D Reinforce the definition of done, and help the team commit to less work so quality is not traded away.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the scrum master do?

A Drop the tests.
Lowers the quality bar to match the shortcut.

B Test later.
Batches quality at the end; defects escape meanwhile.

C Longer sprints.
Treats a commitment problem with a timebox change.

D Hold the DoD; commit to less.
Quality stays fixed; scope per sprint adjusts.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. The definition of done is not negotiable under pressure. Reduce commitment instead.

A hybrid project's forecast now shows costs 11 percent over budget. The governance plan allows the sponsor to approve up to 10 percent; anything beyond goes to the steering committee.

The sponsor asks the project manager to bring it to her alone.

What should the project manager do?

A Bring it to the sponsor alone, as she asked.

B Take it to the steering committee with analysis and options, as the governance plan requires, involving the sponsor.

C Reduce scope quietly to bring the forecast under 10 percent.

D Wait a month to see whether the forecast improves.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Sponsor only.

Beyond her tolerance; the agreed path is the steering committee.

B Steering committee, with the sponsor.

Follows the agreed governance, with analysis and options.

C Cut scope quietly.

Unauthorised change to hide a breach.

D Wait.

Delays a required escalation.

THE SIGNAL

Business Environment domain. Beyond the sponsor's tolerance: the governance path applies, even if asked otherwise.

> All subsidiary plans for a predictive project are drafted. The sponsor, keen to start, tells the project manager to begin execution tomorrow.
>
> The integrated plan and its baselines have not yet been approved.

What should the project manager do?

A Begin execution tomorrow, and seek approval later.

B Begin only the easy work packages while approval is pending.

C Explain that the plan and baselines need approval first, and arrange a quick approval with the sponsor.

D Refuse to start until the steering committee's next scheduled meeting.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Start now; approve later.
No approved baseline to measure or control against.

B Start easy work.
Still executing without an approved baseline.

C Explain; arrange quick approval.
Keeps the discipline and respects the sponsor's urgency.

D Wait for the next meeting.
Rigid; approval can be arranged quickly.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. Approved baselines come before execution. Make approval fast, not optional.

> Two of an agile team's six developers will be on leave for most of the next sprint. The team's recent velocity has been 36 points.
>
> Sprint planning is tomorrow.

How should the team plan the sprint?

A Plan 36 points as usual, and work longer hours to cover.

B Cancel the sprint until everyone is back.

C Borrow two developers from another team for the sprint.

D Plan to the reduced capacity, for example about two thirds of normal, and tell the product owner.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

How should the team plan the sprint?

A Same plan; longer hours.
Unsustainable, and likely to fail.

B Cancel the sprint.
Leave is normal; plan around it.

C Borrow two developers.
Disrupts two teams; new people slow a sprint at first.

D Plan to reduced capacity; inform the PO.
Honest capacity planning, and transparent expectations.

THE SIGNAL

People domain. Plan by capacity, which changes with availability. Keep pace sustainable.

> A project manager is preparing their company's bid for a public contract. A former colleague, now at a competing bidder, emails them the competitor's confidential pricing, saying 'this might help you'.
>
> The bid is due in three days.

What should the project manager do?

A. Not use the information, and report the email through the organisation's ethics or legal process.

B. Use the pricing, since it was sent voluntarily.

C. Delete the email and say nothing.

D. Use it only to check that the bid is not too high.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Don't use; report.

Protects fairness and the company; reporting is the responsible step.

B Use it.

Unfair, and likely unlawful in public procurement.

C Delete silently.

Right not to use it; wrong to hide a possible breach.

D Use it a little.

Any use is use.

THE SIGNAL

Business Environment domain. Confidential competitor data: do not use it, and report it. Fairness and responsibility.

> On a hybrid project, the app team's next release depends on a hardware milestone from the predictive workstream. The hardware milestone is now forecast to slip by two weeks.
>
> The app team has not yet been told.

What should the project manager do?

A Let each team manage its own schedule.

B Tell both teams at once, and work with the product owner to reorder the backlog around the dependency, informing stakeholders of any release impact.

C Crash the hardware work to protect the release.

D Move the release date without discussing options.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the project manager do?

A Leave it to each team.

Integration is the PM's job; the dependency needs coordinating.

B Inform; reorder around it; tell stakeholders.

Integrates the two workstreams at the dependency.

C Crash the hardware.

Commits cost before exploring cheaper options.

D Move the date unilaterally.

Skips options and the people who decide.

THE SIGNAL

Process domain. Hybrid integration: a slipping dependency is coordinated across both workstreams.

> A developer on an agile team tells the project leader she wants to grow into a leadership role. She is respected by the team and skilled at facilitation.
>
> There is no formal leadership vacancy.

What is the best action for the project leader?

A Tell her to wait until a leadership role becomes available.

B Promote her to team lead immediately.

C Create development opportunities, such as facilitating some retrospectives, with mentoring and feedback.

D Suggest she moves to another team with a vacancy.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the best action for the project leader?

A Wait for a vacancy.
Misses the chance to develop her now.

B Promote now.
No vacancy, and not the project leader's decision alone.

C Stretch opportunities, mentoring, feedback.
Develops her skills in real work, within the team.

D Move teams.
Loses a respected member without trying to grow her here.

THE SIGNAL

People domain. Develop people through real opportunities, mentoring and feedback, not just titles.

Scoring guide

DOMAIN	QUESTIONS	YOUR SCORE
People	2, 5, 9, 13, 17, 20	out of 6
Process	1, 4, 6, 7, 10, 11, 14, 16, 19	out of 9
Business Environment	3, 8, 12, 15, 18	out of 5
Total	20 questions	out of 20

ON THE EXAM

Compare with exam 1, domain by domain. A domain weak in both exams is your priority.

What to do with your result

- **Around 16 or more**: strong. Move on to exam 3.
- **Around 13 to 15**: revisit the modules named in the walkthroughs you missed.
- **Below 13**: rewatch your weakest domain's modules before exam 3.
- Did you get question 3 right? It tested whether you noticed the clause that changed exam 1's answer.
- These bands are a study guide, not PMI's standard.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Look for the same distractor pattern across both exams. That is the habit to fix.

Compare domains across exams. **Fix the repeating pattern.** Then take exam 3.